

Most Used Activities



At Phase 6 the emphasis shifts from recognising graphemes and phonemes as children should now be familiar with these patterns, and focuses on using these skills in reading and writing longer text passages. Teachers should focus on correct spelling and grammar usage through these activities, and encourage children to try using spelling strategies in their work to attempt unfamiliar or commonly misspelt words.



Read a Sentence

Teacher writes one or more sentences on the whiteboard or IWB using the lesson focus (i.e. prefix, suffix, homophone, contraction etc.). Children have to silently read in their head, not aloud, then teacher asks for children to support them in reading as they point to each word in the sentence. At the Phase 6 level teachers can present children with multiple sentences ranging in complexity to practise, as their reading comprehension is now more advanced than at earlier phases. Teachers should ensure all children are reading fluently without pauses and understanding how the parts of speech all function together. Teachers can also ask children follow-up comprehension questions to ensure they have understood the text and retained the information from it.



Write a Sentence

Children are asked to write a sentence including a word or a suffix form learnt from the lesson. The emphasis is on using the word correctly in the sentence and spelling accuracy, rather than creative writing, so teachers can provide a wordbank or visual aids to prompt writing. Whereas earlier phases involved children rewriting sentences provided to them, Phase 6 focuses on developing independent writing and spelling skills. Teacher and TAs must ensure the application of correct spelling, Common Exception Words and sentence structure in order to reinforce correct usage. Children can record words they struggle with in a spelling log so they can focus on them and target learning opportunities.

Teacher-Led Activities

Reading Activities



Hands Up, Pair Up

A quick recall or decoding activity. The children are given a card containing a word using the lesson topic (prefix, suffix, contraction etc.). Children walk around the classroom to music. When the music stops the children put their hands up and pair up. The children look at their words and say aloud, then blend to read the word to their partner. They then swap cards and the activity continues more rounds. The teachers focus is to listen to children pronouncing the words correctly.



Lucky Dip

A quick word-decoding activity. The teacher has a collection of words containing the lesson topic (prefix, suffix, contraction etc.) and secretly writes one on a whiteboard. Each child is given a word card that they read, and then share with a partner. The teacher supports the activity ensuring all children have read their word correctly then reveals the word and the 'lucky dip' winner is the child whose card matches the teacher.



Which Phoneme / Grapheme / Vowel / Suffix?

A teacher-led activity for comparing different words and their attributes. Children are given a mixture of word cards with similar attributes and must distinguish which phoneme/ grapheme / vowel they think is used for each word and why.



Countdown

A quick word-decoding activity. The teacher has a list of words on the whiteboard containing the lesson topic (prefix, suffix, contraction etc.) which are covered and the teacher reveals one word at a time. Children must be seen to be segmenting and then blending to read before revealing the next word on the list. A sand timer can be used for fun to complete the list before the time runs out.



Take Off, Touch Down

A quick word-decoding game. Children sit in a circle and are given cards with words containing the lesson topic. In turn, each child stands up, segments the word then blends to read the word. The children on the carpet listen and then the child reading reveals the

word to the group. The children can give a thumbs up to agree the word has been read correctly, then say the word together. The child with the word card reaches it high in the air (like a rocket) and then sits down as the touchdown. Repeat until all children have had a turn.



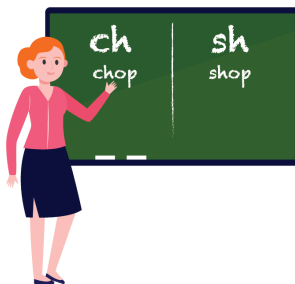
Yes or No

An activity for reading words in sentences and testing knowledge. Use prepared questions with yes or no answers, and present on whiteboard or IWB. Children are encouraged to read the sentence in their head (not aloud) or along with the teacher. Children can respond to the sentence by writing yes or no on whiteboards or stick thumbs up or down. Teachers correct as needed.



Sentence Substitution

Use a number of prepared sentences that are missing words and display a list of possible words for each sentence. Ask children to read the sentence with their partner, then change a word in the sentence to see if it makes sense. Continue substituting words to make new sentences. Teachers can ask the children to swap the words (for example swap with opposite adjectives) and discuss with them how it changes the meaning.



Writing / Spelling Activities

Best Guess

A teacher-led activity for comparing two words or their attributes. The whiteboard/ IWB or a piece of paper is divided into separate columns. The teacher reads a selection of words and the children need to sort which column the words go into (comparisons include; grapheme, phoneme, type of word, type of suffix to add, which homophone to use etc.).



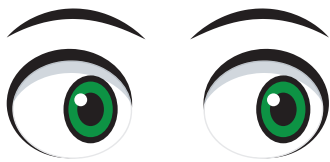
Stash and Flash

A quick word-writing activity. Teacher reads out a word. The children then write down the spelling on paper or a whiteboard, hide it, then show it together to the teacher. Teacher corrects as needed, with a focus on checking words with suffixes added are spelt correctly.

Decoding and Encoding Mnemonic

The following mnemonics are used to support the understanding and visualisation of the processes of decoding and encoding.

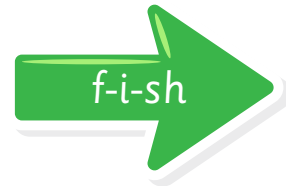
Decoding



look
for the key graphemes



chop
the word by sounding each phoneme

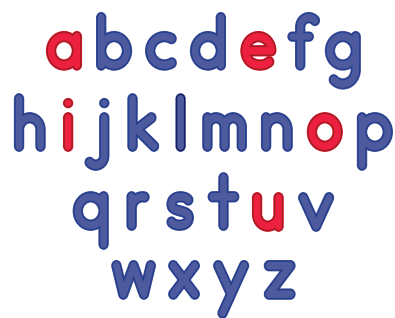


blend
the phonemes to read the word

Encoding



listen
to the phonemes



change
phoneme to grapheme



build
a word